# Accessible PDFs

Inclusion Toolkit

## What is it for?

PDF (Portable Document Format) is used to present all kinds of documents. Ideally, all the content in a PDF should be accessible to all. Here are some ways to make it accessible:

- Enable tagging, and set the title and language, so screen readers can navigate the content
- Design with high colour contrast, legible fonts, and a single-column layout including headers and footers
- Test the final document with a screen reader and a PDF Accessibility Checker

## How to support it

Avoid PDFs whenever possible. Even ‘accessible’ ones aren't natively responsive for mobile and have major downsides. Instead, challenge the PDF requirement and choose an alternative:

- Semantic HTML web pages or web apps for the most accessible experience
- Word documents, Google Docs, or slide presentations, as they offer built-in accessibility checkers and excellent screen reader support
- ePub or Markdown formats to ensure reflowable text and clean semantic structures across all devices

## Useful Links

Reading PDFs with reflow and accessibility features

Adobe: Creating accessible PDFs